

# Diabetes Overview

## DIABETES OVERVIEW

### What is Diabetes?

Diabetes is a chronic condition that affects how your body processes blood sugar (glucose). There are three main types of diabetes: Type 1, Type 2, and Gestational diabetes.

### Type 1 Diabetes:

- Autoimmune condition where pancreas doesn't produce insulin
- Typically diagnosed in children and young adults
- Requires daily insulin injections or pump therapy

### Type 2 Diabetes:

- Most common form (90-95% of cases)
- Body doesn't use insulin effectively (insulin resistance)
- Often associated with obesity and sedentary lifestyle
- Can often be managed with lifestyle changes and medication

### Symptoms:

- Increased thirst
- Frequent urination
- Fatigue
- Blurred vision
- Slow healing of cuts or wounds

### Risk Factors:

- Family history of diabetes
- Obesity
- Physical inactivity
- Poor diet high in sugar and processed foods
- Age over 45 years old

### Management:

- Blood sugar monitoring
- Healthy diet and exercise
- Medication (if prescribed)
- Regular medical checkups
- Stress management

### Complications:

- Heart disease and stroke
- Kidney disease
- Vision problems (diabetic retinopathy)
- Nerve damage (neuropathy)
- Foot problems

### Prevention:

- Maintain healthy weight
- Exercise regularly (150 minutes per week)

- Eat healthy diet rich in vegetables
- Reduce sugar and processed food intake
- Get regular checkups